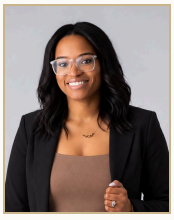
The Central Ohio School District Research Guide

Everything you need to research your school district before making your next housing decision.

DELAWARE · FAIRFIELD · FRANKLIN · MADISON · MARION · MORROW · UNION



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INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Five steps, all from official sources

Each step points you to the public record that answers one question. You don't need an account or a fee for any of them.

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For buyers, sellers and homeowners staying put

Start where you are

Buying

Do steps 1 through 4 for every address you're seriously considering, then fill in a worksheet (page 9) for each.

Selling

Use steps 1, 3 and 4 to gather the facts buyers ask about. Page 8 lists what to have ready.

Staying

Steps 3 through 5 show what may change your tax bill and how to check your credits and valuation.

About the information in this guide. Rules, rates and results change. Every figure in this guide is an example or a description of how a process works, current as of November 2026. Always confirm specifics with the official source named in each step.

STEP ONE

I Confirm the district for an address

A home's school district is set by its parcel, not its mailing city or ZIP code. Two houses with the same city in their address can sit in different districts and pay different taxes.

How to look it up

1. Open the county auditor's property search for the county where the home sits (table below).
2. Search by street address or parcel number.
3. On the parcel record, find the **school district** or **taxing district** field.
4. Write down the district name and the tax district number. You'll use both in steps 3 and 4.

Watch for county lines

Some districts serve more than one county. Dublin City Schools, for example, serves parts of Franklin, Delaware and Union counties, and Pickerington Local Schools serves parts of Fairfield and Franklin.

For those districts, the parcel's own county auditor is the source for that home's taxes, and every county's board of elections reports part of each levy vote.

County auditor property search

COUNTY	WHERE TO SEARCH
Delaware	Find the Delaware County Auditor through the County Auditors' Association of Ohio directory caao.org/auditors-directory
Fairfield	Fairfield County Auditor fairfieldcountyohio.gov/auditor
Franklin	Franklin County Auditor franklincountyauditor.com
Madison	Find the Madison County Auditor through the County Auditors' Association of Ohio directory caao.org/auditors-directory
Marion	Marion County Auditor property search propertysearch.marioncountyohio.gov
Morrow	Find the Morrow County Auditor through the County Auditors' Association of Ohio directory caao.org/auditors-directory
Union	Union County Auditor unioncountyohio.gov/departments/auditor

Tip: If a listing names a school district, still confirm it on the auditor's parcel record. Listings can carry over errors from earlier sales.

STEP TWO

2 Read an Ohio School Report Card

Each year the Ohio Department of Education and Workforce publishes a report card for every public school district and school building in the state.

What it measures

Report cards use star ratings across several components, along with an overall rating. Components include:

- **Achievement**: how students performed on state tests
- **Progress**: how much students grew from one year to the next
- **Gap Closing**: how well groups of students are meeting expectations
- **Early Literacy**: reading progress in the early grades
- **Graduation**: four- and five-year graduation rates

The site also reports measures such as college, career, workforce and military readiness.

How to read it well

1. **Look past the overall rating.** Open each component to see what drives it.
2. **Check more than one year.** A single year can move for many reasons.
3. **Look at buildings as well as the district.** The specific schools that serve an address have their own report cards.
4. **Read the notes.** The site explains how each measure is calculated.

Where to find it

Ohio School Report Cards

reportcard.education.ohio.gov

Search by district or school name. The district name comes from step 1.

A note on schools and housing decisions. Report cards are one source of information among many. To learn about programs, transportation, enrollment or anything else specific, contact the district directly. This guide doesn't rate or rank districts, and it isn't a substitute for your own research.

STEP THREE

3 Find levy and election results

School levies and bond issues go to voters, and the results can change what homeowners pay. County boards of elections are the official source.

Where results come from

- **Election night results are unofficial.** Counties certify official results after counting provisional and late absentee ballots.
- **Multi-county districts** appear on more than one county's results. Add every county's votes together for the districtwide outcome.
- **Ballot language** is published before each election. It states the rate, the term and what the money is for.

Where to find it

Ohio Secretary of State directory of county boards of elections

ohiosos.gov › county boards of elections directory

County links are listed on page 10.

Levy types, in plain language

Additional	New money. Raises taxes if approved.
Renewal	Continues an expiring levy, generally at the rate already being paid.
Replacement	Continues a levy but recalculates it at current values, which can increase it.
Fixed-sum	Emergency or substitute levies that raise a set dollar amount.
Bond issue	Repays borrowing for buildings. The rate can change over the life of the bond.
Permanent improvement	Pays for buildings, equipment and other long-lasting items.
School income tax	Paid on residents' income rather than property value.

Ohio changed several levy rules in 2025–26. Your county auditor can tell you how a specific issue works.

Reading a ballot issue

- ☐ **Type:** new, renewal, replacement, bond or income tax?
- ☐ **Rate:** mills for property tax, or a percentage for income tax
- ☐ **Term:** a set number of years, or continuing
- ☐ **Purpose:** operating costs, buildings, or permanent improvements
- ☐ **Estimated cost:** the county auditor's estimate, often stated per $100,000 of home value
- ☐ **Start date:** the first tax year it would be collected

STEP FOUR

4 Understand what you'll pay in taxes

School funding reaches households two ways: property taxes on the home, and in some districts, an income tax on residents.

How property tax is calculated

1. **Market value** is set by the county auditor.
2. **Assessed value** is 35% of market value.
3. **Millage** is applied to assessed value. One mill is $1 per $1,000 of assessed value.

A new 1-mill levy costs about **$35 a year per $100,000** of market value, before credits.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE ONLY

Auditor market value	$300,000
Assessed value (35%)	$105,000
New 1-mill levy	$105 / yr
New 3-mill levy	$315 / yr
New 5-mill levy	**$525 / yr**

Ohio's tax reduction factors generally keep voted levies from collecting more as values rise, so actual bills don't simply track this math.

School district income tax

Many Ohio districts also tax residents' income. A **traditional** school income tax applies to a broad base of income on the Ohio return. An **earned income** tax applies only to wages and self-employment income.

Check any address

The Finder, from the Ohio Department of Taxation

thefinder.tax.ohio.gov

Credits and valuation

- **Owner-occupancy credit:** available on a homeowner's primary residence. Confirm with the auditor that it's on your bill.
- **Homestead exemption:** available to qualifying seniors and homeowners with disabilities, subject to rules set by the state.
- **Board of Revision:** if you disagree with your home's appraised value, the county Board of Revision hears complaints. Ask the auditor about the yearly filing deadline.

Recent changes to Ohio property tax law

Ohio enacted several property tax changes in 2025 and 2026 (including House Bills 124, 129, 186, 309 and 335), affecting owner-occupied credits and limits on some increases. Because the details depend on your county and your district's levies, ask your county auditor how they apply to your bill.

STEP FIVE

5 Look at the district's finances

Ohio school districts file a five-year financial forecast each fall and update it in the spring. It shows where a district expects its money to come from and go over the next five years.

What to look for

- **Revenue compared with spending.** Is the district projecting to spend more than it brings in, and starting when?
- **Ending cash balance.** How much is projected to remain at the end of each year?
- **Levy assumptions.** Does the forecast assume a renewal or a new levy passes?
- **The written notes.** The treasurer explains enrollment, staffing and state funding assumptions.

Where to find it

- The district treasurer's page on the district's own website
- The Ohio Department of Education and Workforce education.ohio.gov
- Board of education meeting agendas and minutes, where forecasts are presented and approved

Why it matters for a home

A forecast can signal whether a district may ask voters for a levy in the next few years. That can affect future tax bills for every homeowner in the district.

Questions worth asking the district

- When does the district expect to place its next issue on the ballot, if at all?
- Which existing levies expire in the next few years?
- Where can residents find board meeting schedules and public comment opportunities?

Buying, selling, or staying

The same records answer different questions depending on where you are.

If you're buying

- ☐ Confirm the school district on the auditor's parcel record for each address.
- ☐ Ask the lender to include property taxes and any school income tax in your monthly estimate.
- ☐ Remember the seller's tax bill reflects their credits. Yours may differ.
- ☐ Check recent levy results and the district's five-year forecast.
- ☐ Contact the district directly with questions about programs or enrollment.

If you're selling

- ☐ Have the school district, yearly taxes and any school income tax rate ready to share.
- ☐ List improvements you've made, with approximate dates.
- ☐ Know what similar homes nearby have recently sold for.
- ☐ Note any recent or upcoming levies so you can answer buyer questions accurately.
- ☐ Prepare a one-page fact sheet drawn from public records.

If you're staying

- ☐ Review your tax bill and confirm the credits you qualify for are applied.
- ☐ Follow upcoming levies and renewals in your district.
- ☐ Watch for reappraisal notices from the county auditor.
- ☐ If you disagree with a valuation, ask about the Board of Revision deadline.
- ☐ Keep records of improvements for when you eventually sell.

Do levy results change home values?

Not automatically. Home prices reflect interest rates, inventory, condition, location and many other factors. A single election result is one input among many, and its effect, if any, varies by market and over time. For a specific home, a current comparative market analysis is the reliable tool.

Fair housing. This guide shares public information so every reader can make their own decisions. It does not describe any district or neighborhood as better or worse, and every reader receives the same information.

WORKSHEET

District research worksheet

Fill in one for each address you're considering. Print as many copies as you need.

Property address

County

School district
From the auditor's parcel record (step 1)

Tax district number

Current yearly property taxes
From the auditor (step 4)

School income tax
Type and rate from The Finder

Credits on the current bill

Report card notes
Overall and components (step 2)

Recent levies and results
From the board of elections (step 3)

Upcoming or expiring levies

Five-year forecast notes
Step 5

Questions to ask

DIRECTORY

Official resources

All of these are free public resources. Links were checked in November 2026. Where a county's own site wasn't confirmed, the statewide directory is listed instead.

Statewide

Ohio School Report Cards	reportcard.education.ohio.gov
Ohio Department of Education and Workforce	education.ohio.gov
Ohio Department of Taxation	tax.ohio.gov
The Finder (school income tax lookup)	thefinder.tax.ohio.gov
County boards of elections directory	ohiosos.gov › elections › county boards of elections directory
County auditors directory	caao.org/auditors-directory

By county

COUNTY	BOARD OF ELECTIONS	AUDITOR
Delaware	vote.delawarecountyohio.gov	Use the auditors directory
Fairfield	boe.ohio.gov/fairfield	fairfieldcountyohio.gov/auditor
Franklin	vote.franklincountyohio.gov	franklincountyauditor.com
Madison	Use the boards of elections directory	Use the auditors directory
Marion	Use the boards of elections directory	propertysearch.marioncountyohio.gov
Morrow	Use the boards of elections directory	Use the auditors directory
Union	unioncountyohio.gov/board-of-elections	unioncountyohio.gov/departments/auditor

Explore online. Central Ohio School District Insights links to each of these resources for every district in the seven counties, organized by an interactive county map.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Questions about a specific home?

Whether you're planning a move or staying put, I'm glad to walk through the school district, tax and levy records for any address, along with what's happening in the local market. No pressure and no obligation.



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